

How to use these token cutouts

These pages contain the text *Sycophancy* by LLMs Unplugged (147 tokens, entropy 0.7 bits/token, perplexity 1.6). Each **cutout** shows a **next word** paired with the **previous word** that came immediately before it in the original text.

Anatomy of a cutout



Every distinct word has its own colour. **Previous** words appear inside a coloured box (the word's own colour as the background, with white text); the free-standing **next word** appears in plain coloured text. The same word always wears the same colour, whether you see it inside a box or free-standing. Two unrelated words can occasionally share a colour, so always verify the word itself matches—not just the colour.

Setup

Cut out the tokens along the dotted lines and **spread them out** face-up on the table, with no overlap if possible. This is the “training” step: every (previous, next) combination from the original text is now a physical cutout sitting on your table.

How to play: the matching game

To generate text, repeatedly find a cutout whose **previous word** matches the last word you've written, then **write its next word** onto your page. The word you just wrote becomes part of what you'll match against next—that's the chain.

Worked example

Step 1. Pick any cutout to begin—say this one:

That's a

Copy its previous word *and* its next word onto your page. Your text so far:

That's a

Step 2. Look at the last word you've written (in this case *a*) and find a cutout whose previous word matches it, like this one:

a great

Write its next word onto your page. Your text now reads:

That's a great

Step 3. Repeat. The last word you've now written is *great*—find another matching cutout:

great insight

Add its next word. Your text now reads:

That's a great insight

Keep going—write as much or as little as you like.

Tips

- **Use colour as a fast filter.** Scan by the rightmost previous-word box's colour first, then verify the actual word matches.
- **Pick from many candidates by eye.** The more cutouts share the same previous word, the more often your eye lands on one—that's **weighted sampling** for free, and it's why some words follow others more often in your text.
- **Put the cutout back** after using it—removing it would change the model's distribution next time round.

You're **You're** absolutely **absolutely** right **right** .

. That's **That's** a **a** great **great** insight **insight** .

. What **What** a **a** thoughtful

thoughtful question **question** . . You're

You're absolutely **absolutely** right **right** . . I

I completely **completely** agree **agree** . . That's

That's brilliant **brilliant** . . You're

You're absolutely **absolutely** right **right** .

. That's **That's** a **a** great **great** insight **insight** .

. What **What** a **a** wonderful **wonderful** point

point . . You **You** make **make** an **an** excellent

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You're absolutely absolutely right right .

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